

provided in either of two ways. One is by saving \$150,000, in which case insurance is not necessary. The other is with life insurance. Even if a family *has* \$150,000 but wants to use it to buy a home, the insurance provides substitute collateral. In other words, it frees \$150,000 that could be used currently or could be given away if desired.

● THE LIABILITIES OF OWNING INSURANCE

One liability of insurance is that it costs money. So you must give up current spending in order to provide for the future. If you need \$150,000 of insurance, then it will cost money from your current budget. For the sake of example, let's assume that your insurance will cost \$25 a month. So you must free \$25 a month in earnings to fund it.

The second liability of insurance is that it can divert your dependency from God. Solomon wrote, "Trust in the Lord with all of your heart, and do not lean on your own understanding. In all of your ways acknowledge Him, and He will make your paths straight" (Proverbs 3:5-6). We are to trust in the Lord, not insurance. That doesn't mean to forgo all use of insurance, just that we are not to use it to "protect" or profit.

I counseled an airline pilot who was spending \$500 a month for disability insurance. If he had lost his pilot's license, he could have lived without working. It was obvious that he wasn't using insurance to provide. He was living in fear and trusting in his insurance.

That leads us to the third liability of insurance: people use it to profit. I think of a man I counseled who parked his car in a downtown parking lot and came back to find it dented up pretty badly. The "banger" didn't leave a note on his car and as a consequence, he ended up with damage on his car that he couldn't fix, since he didn't carry comprehensive insurance. A few weeks later, somebody accidentally hit him from behind in almost the same spot. When the damage was appraised, he "forgot" to mention the previous damage. As a result, he got both dents fixed. He assumed the second accident was a blessing from God. It wasn't a blessing from God; it was deceit. He

